# Austin on Performatives **(if subtitle != none { parbreak() text(size: subtitle-size)[] })**

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Read Austin (1961):

- "Performative Utterances"

This was first published in Austin's *Philosophical Papers*, a collection of his work published shortly after his unexpected death from lung cancer, at the age of 48, in 1960. It is a lightly edited transcript of a lecture he gave on the topic on the BBC in 1956. I have not been able to find the original audio of that lecture. The Harvard Philosophy Department has posted the audio from a talk on the subject that Austin gave at the University of Gothenberg, Sweden, in 1959, if you are curious.

I also want you to read a short selection from Lecture VIII of Austin (1962). It amounts to about 12 pages—I've crossed out the paragraphs that you are free to skip. This is from a series of lectures he gave in 1955. In this short selection, he makes a distinction between *locutionary*, *illocutionary*, and *perlocutionary* acts. (In the crossed out sections, he further subdivides locutionary acts into three kinds—it is interesting, and connects back to Frege!)

- Lecture VIII

## Slides and Handouts

- Slides
- Handout

## References

Austin, J. L. 1961. "Performative Utterances." In *Philosophical Papers*, edited by J. O. Urmson and G. J. Warnock. Oxford University Press.

Austin, J. L. 1962. *How to Do Things with Words*. Oxford University Press.